



YOU ARE **11 WEEKS AND 5 DAYS**

198 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

At this stage the eye—not yet in its final position—still dominates the appearance of the face. The eye is not yet responsive to light and remains well protected behind the covering eyelid.

“ Having your first scan this week, and knowing your risk of miscarriage is reduced now, should mean you can start to relax. ”

This can be a very positive time for you, especially if you’ve been anxious from day one of your pregnancy. The risk of miscarriage falls as your pregnancy progresses and by the end of this 12th week, it’s no more than 1 percent.

As you enter the second trimester, you should begin to [feel better](#), and this, combined with the knowledge that you have passed the most risky time, may help you relax. If you’ve been keeping your pregnancy a secret, you can also enjoy telling others.

SAFE SCANS

Medical ultrasound has been used since the early 1960s. However, the first discovery of high-frequency echo-sounding techniques, was as long ago as 1880 in Paris. It was not until the 1940s that research began into its use as a diagnostic tool.

Children who’ve been exposed to prenatal ultrasound do not have differences in speech, hearing, vision, or school performance, or an increased risk of cancer.

Although it is safe, ultrasound should only be carried out when it is necessary to do so.

ASK A NUTRITIONIST

I have a really sweet tooth. Is it okay to indulge this while I’m pregnant? You don’t want to deny yourself sweet foods for the whole pregnancy, but too many candies and cookies may fill you up without providing other vital nutrients your baby needs. So occasional treats are fine, but don’t let them take the place of more nutritious foods. A small treat after you’ve eaten a meal is preferable to replacing your lunch with cake.

It’s a good idea to carry nutritious snacks with you or keep them at work. That way when you feel like a nibble you have something on hand rather than being tempted by a sweet treat from a deli or vending machine. Small bags of dried apricots, prunes, and raisins are sweet and also provide fiber and essential iron.

To help curb your sweet tooth, eat regular meals. This helps to steady your blood-sugar level and may reduce cravings. Try to drink plenty of water each day, since sometimes you may be